

Cecilia Y. Sui

Seigle Hall 278, Department of Political Science,
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EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO

Ph.D., Political Science, expected May 2027

M.A., Political Science, 2025

Committee: Jacob Montgomery (co-chair), Christopher Lucas (co-chair), Ted Enamorado, and Taylor Carlson

Subfields: Political Methodology (Major), American Politics (Minor)

Lipscomb University, Nashville, TN

B.S., in Computer Science (minor in Political Science), 2020

PUBLICATION

Cecilia Y. Sui. “High Accuracy with Low Costs: The Pretrain-Finetune Paradigm for Classification with Transformer-Based Language Models” (*Political Science Research and Methods*, forthcoming.)

WORKING PAPER

Cecilia Y. Sui, Soyeon Jeon, Christopher Lucas, Jacob Montgomery, and Margit Tavits. “One Language is Enough: Using Transfer Learning to Detect Populist Rhetoric Across 25 Languages Without Translation” (NSF#2215008 and Carnegie#G-23-60440) (Under Review)

WORK IN PROGRESS

Cecilia Y. Sui. “Should Candidates Campaign Like Influencers? Evidence From 16,572 Instagram Reels and Two Generative AI Video Experiments”

Cecilia Y. Sui. “Seeing Inside the Black Box: Feature Attribution for Political Text in the Age of Language Models”

GRANTS & AWARDS

2026 WashU Weidenbaum Center Research Grant on Non-Textual Political Communication with Prof. Jacob Montgomery and Christopher Lucas (\$9,365)

WashU Political Science Department Travel Grant (\$500)

WashU Political Science Department Dissertation Seed Grant (\$600)

2025 WashU Dissertation Research Grant (\$1000)

WashU Political Science Department Travel Grant (\$900)

Google Cloud Research Grant (\$1000)

2023 WashU Antoinette Dames Prize for Best Graduate Level Paper (\$3000)

WashU LSQ Research Grant (\$5000)

WashU Political Science Department Travel Grant (\$900)

PolMeth NSF Summer Travel Grant (\$900)

MPSA Travel Grant (\$500)

INVITED TALK

2023 Peking University (PKU Analytics Lab for Global Risk Politics)

CONFERENCES

2026 APSA (scheduled)
PolMeth Annual Summer Meeting (poster)
Visions in Methodology
MPSA (paper)
2025 PolMeth Annual Summer Meeting (paper)
APSA (paper)
2023 MPSA (paper)
PolMeth Annual Summer Meeting (poster)
2022 MPSA

SERVICE

2024 Moderator of PolMeth ListServ
2023 Moderator of PolMeth ListServ
Department Graduate Student Mentor

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2023 – 2024 Research Assistant for Jacob Montgomery and Christopher Lucas, Washington University St. Louis
2021 – 2022 Research Assistant for Taylor Carlson and Carly Wayne, Washington University St. Louis

TEACHING

Independent Instructor:
Introduction to Python (Graduate), Summer 2023
Introduction to R Programming (Graduate), Winter 2022

Assistant Instructor:
Quantitative Political Methodology (Undergraduate, Ted Enamorado), Spring 2023
Quantitative Political Methodology II (Graduate, Jacob Montgomery), Fall 2022
Introduction to Python (Graduate, Annamaria Prati), Summer 2022
Quantitative Political Methodology I (Graduate, Ted Enamorado), Spring 2022
Mathematical Modeling (Graduate, Ted Enamorado), Fall 2021

SKILLS

Language: Mandarin-Chinese, English
Programming: R, Python, HTML/CSS, Java, C, SQL, LATEX
API and Tools: Twitter, TikTok, Meta Content Library, OpenAI, Claude Code, Azure, Amazon Mechanical Turk, HuggingFace, Upwork, Qualtrics, Prolific